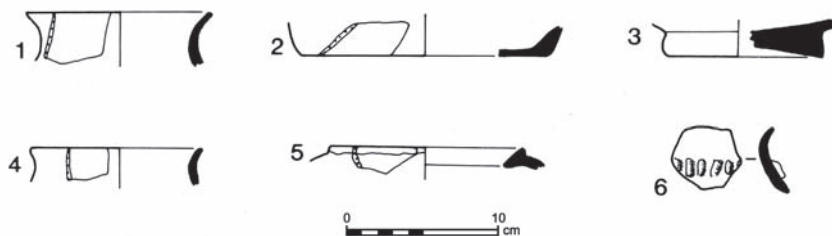


part of the courtyard are two built rooms, each about 3X4 m in size.

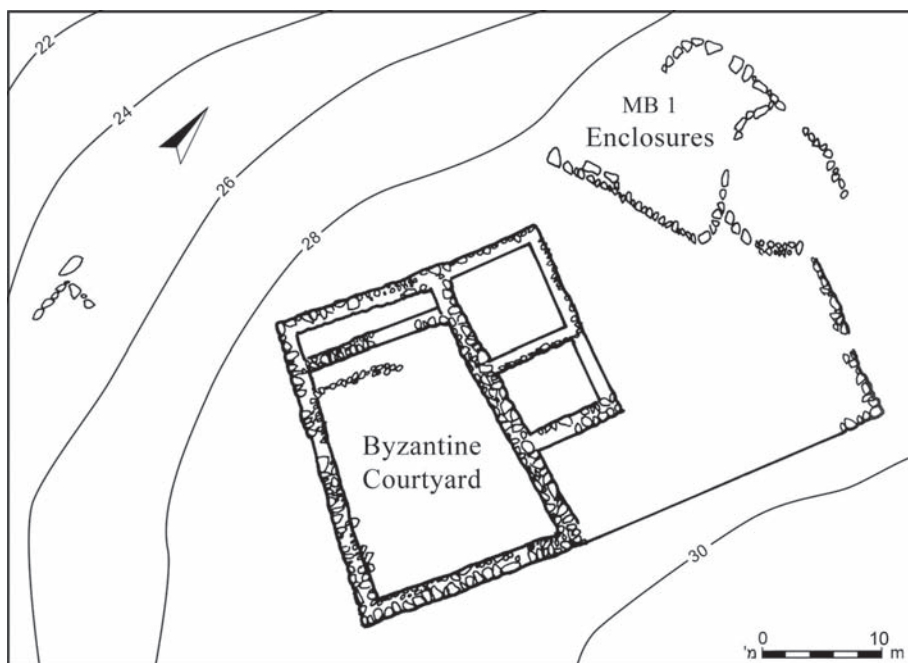
The courtyard, apparently built during the Byzantine Period, is situated in the center of the site from Middle Bronze Age I. It included units of courtyards or enclosures, generally round or elliptical in shape. At least three such units were

discernible on the surface, built of small field stones, together with solitary walls.

About 0.1 km north of the site a square tower built of large stones was found. About 0.3 km south of the site, on the summit (Israel grid 1905 1973), there is another structure of large stones, 7x7 m in size.



477. Pottery from the site, all MBA I except for no. 3: 1-2, 4. Jars, gray; 3. Bowl base, Byz; 5. HM jar; 6. rope dec, lt.



478. Plan of the site at Re'us et-Tabaq.

Its walls are 1.2 m wide and its entrance is on the north side. These structures have probably belonged to the central site.

The northern tower appears on the SWP map, Sheet XII, marked (R) for 'ruin'.

Pottery: MBA I – 90%; Byz – 10%.

Flint find: MBA I (the majority) and unidentifiable items; see appendix.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 235: 19 - 18/79/1

E.P. 118

Israel grid: 1977 1898

UTM grid: 7355 5770

Elevation: 114 m a.s.l., 80 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: enclosure

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: high summit

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: springs ('Uyun Hilu, no. 88), 3 km distant

Nearest road: Wadi el-Far'ah – Tel el-Hilu (C23), 1.2 km distant

Visibility: 8

Feb. 12, 1988; 27 shards and two flint items

* * *

A site on a high, narrow ridge surrounded by deep wadis. It overlooks the Jordan Valley, Tabqet el-Hilweh, Ras Ramali and Nahal Bezeq to the north, and the Buqei'ah to the south and west. The ridge is

In the well preserved site there is a round or elliptical courtyard, about 35 m in diameter. The courtyard is surrounded by an enclosure wall built of large stones and with gaps in the wall. Along the enclosure-wall, on the inside, 2-3 rooms of an average size of 2x4 m are discernable. An additional, smaller courtyard adjoins the large one on

the eastern side.

About 0.2 km to the southeast, on an adjacent summit, is a 5x5 m structure built of large stones, with Byzantine Period shards nearby.

Pottery: MBA I – 100% (in the enclosure). Three MBA II shards.

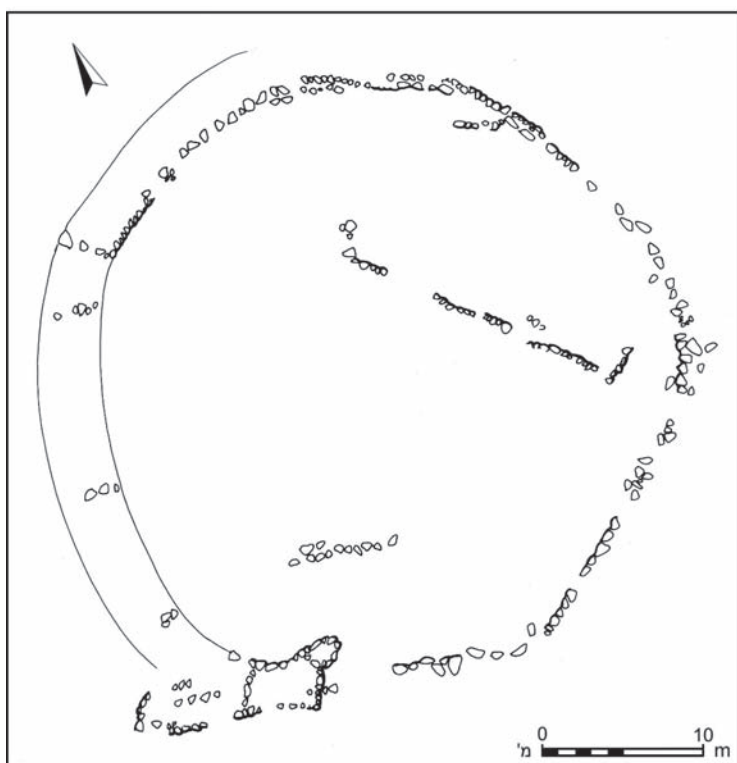
Flint find: Two unidentified items.

This dwelling enclosures are similar in structure to the 'classic' sites of this period. Its elevated location, and the three shards of Middle Bronze Age II, are surprising. The pottery find is small in quantity.

Previous surveys: none.



479. The range of E.P. 118, viewed from the south. The site is in the center of the range. The road leads to Tabqet el-Hilweh.



480. Plan of the Middle Bronze Age I enclosure at E.P. 118. Such MBA 1 enclosures are few in the Manasseh Hill Country.

Site 236: 19 – 18/79/2

Wadi Ra'us el-Kuw'ah

Israel grid: 1975 1896

UTM grid: 7342 5766

Elevation: s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small farm

Area: 1.5 dunams (0.38 acre)

Topography: ridge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest

soil; quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: springs ('Uyun Hilu, no. 88), 3.8 km distant

Nearest road: Wadi el-Far'ah – Tel el-Hilu (C23), 1 km distant

Visibility: 2

Mar. 18, 1988; 47 shards

* * *

A site on a wide and low ridge in an inner valley between crossing wadis, about 2.5 km north of Kh. es-Samrah.

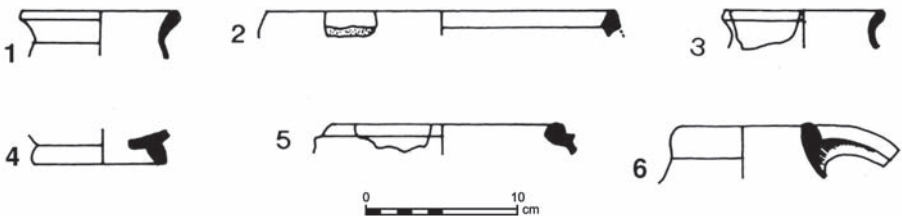
In the southern part are two parallel walls 25 m long and 6 m distant from each other, built of field stones. In the space between the walls there seems to be rooms. One of the walls turns north to create a possible courtyard, 25x25 m in size

and empty of structures. A parallel enclosure was possibly existent on the eastern side. A large shard scatter was found on the site.

The site is most probably a farm dating to the 7th-6th centuries BCE, a typical settlement in East Manasseh.

Pottery: IrA III – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



481. Pottery from Wadi Ra'us el-Kuw'ah, all from IrA III: 1, 3, 6. Jars, br; 2. Bowl, yel; 4. Jug base, lt; 5. CP, br.

Site 237: 19 – 18/68/1

Wadi Abu Dayah

Israel grid: 1964 1888

UTM grid: 7342 5757

Elevation: 10 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: structure

Area: 0.3 dunam (0.08 acre)

Topography: ravine

Rock type: Mount Scopus formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: springs ('Uyun Hilu, no. 88), 4 km distant

Nearest road: Wadi el-Far'ah – Tel el-Hilu (C23), passes by site

Visibility: 1

Mar. 1, 1989; two shards

* * *

A solitary structure in a ravine, next and east to the road from Tel el-Hilu to Beqa'ot, and about 1.5 north of Kh. es-Samrah.

The structure, of large field stones, is 11x15 m in size with

no discerned entrance. Its western wall was especially prominent. Few shards were collected.

Pottery: Byz – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



482. Remains of the structure at Wadi Abu Dayah.

Site 238: 19 – 18/78/1

Ra'us el-Kuw'ah

Israel grid: 1970 1882

UTM grid: 5755 7351

Elevation: 63 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: shard scatter

Area: 10 dunams (2.5 acres)

Topography: saddle

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest

soil; quality: 3

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: springs ('Uyun Hilu, no. 88), 5 km distant

Nearest road: Wadi el-Far'ah – Tel el-Hilu (C23), 0.8 km distant

Visibility: 4

Mar. 18, 1988; 30 shards

* * *

A site on a broad, partially cultivated ridge, overlooking Moshav Beqa'ot to the south. The site is 1 km north of Kh. es-Samrah.

There is a shard scatter, dated

to the Byzantine and Early Moslem Periods, over an area of about 10 dunams (2.5 acres), with no structural remains. The main concentration was to the southeast of E.P. 73. There are few shards from



483. The landscape of Ra'us el-Kuw'ah and its surroundings, looking west. In the background to the left are the Buqei'ah and Jebel Kebir; in the center are the Musheibik Hills and Wadi Fau.

the Middle Bronze Age 1 (a folded EM – 40%.
ledge handle).

Previous surveys: none.

Pottery: MBA I – 10%; Byz – 50%;



Site 239: 19 – 18/98/1

Khirbet es-Suweideh (also on SWP map)

Israel grid: 1997 1887

UTM grid: 7377 7558

Elevation: 60 m a.s.l., 30 m b.s.a.

Name type: historical site

Site type: tell and large military camp

Area: 40 dunams (10 acres)

Topography: ridge and edge of internal valley

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 50

Nearest water source: springs ('Uyun Hilu, no. 88), 5 km distant

Nearest road: Wadi el-Far'ah – Tel el-Hilu (C23), 3 km distant

Visibility: 4

Jun. 17, 1988; Feb. 10, 1993; 112

shards and four coins

* * *

A large, permanent army base on a broad ridge, descending south into a small, internal valley. It is located in the hilly part of the Manasseh fringes, between Wadi Feiran and Wadi esh-Shaqq, about 2 km north-east of Peles.

A. The camp complex containing five parts:

1. The central enclosure is a large rectangle suited to the topography, whose original dimensions were 188x100 m. It was originally surrounded by a 1.3 m wide wall, whose remains are seen here and there. In a few sections a double enclosure wall, with a space of 5 m between the two walls, is discern-

able. The enclosure walls are visible in most parts of the site, but in various places it has been damaged by later activities. The area within the enclosure is completely built up with crowded, massive stone constructions, whose fallen stones cover the entire site. This area is divided into streets running east – west (4 m wide) and north – south (2 – 3 m wide). Most of the east – west streets are opened through the enclosure wall. Between the net of streets there are blocks 10X10 m I dimensions.

The blocks are divided into structural complexes with many rooms, inner squares, passages and lanes. Most of the rooms, with stone

doorposts *in situ*, are about 4x4 m in size. Many of the streets and lanes are equipped with inner gates with bolt holes, which enabled to close the passages.

This division into structural blocks is in the northern two thirds of the camp's area. The southern area, about one third of the total, is built differently. The higher level of fallen stones suggests a second storey, while street blockings are here as well. In the center of the southern part, facing north, there is a strong tower, 10x10 m in size and built of very large stones with hewn edges. The tower is 2-3 m higher than the level of fallen rocks. North of the tower is a long hall with a fallen pillar and a hewn basin with a rough relief on one side.

On the southwest side of the enclosure are courtyards with a concentration of large cisterns, and a built entranceway, leading up to the tower; these seems to be later than the original building. On the north side at least two more towers, smaller than the central one, are discernable.

2. The additions beyond the original camp: On all sides of the camp, various additions are discernable: in the west a large area of structures has been added to the camp, covering about 10 dunams (2.5 acres). It contains complexes of buildings whose plan and building method are similar to those of the camp inside. This western "wing" suits the central camp, and apparently was an extension of it. On the



484. A bird's eye view, looking west, at the camp of Kh. es-Suweideh. Note the network of streets. At up left is the beginning of Wadi Feiran.

northern part of the western “wing” a built entrance, protected by a *clavicula*, is visible. In the north, additional structures, most of them divided into rooms, jut out from the camp’s wall. In the east there is a special “wing” that deviates from the straight lines that define the entire camp. In this section, built at an 45° angle to the enclosure wall, the buildings suit the slope line. The slanted street goes off from the entrance to one of the wide streets, and blocks of buildings to the north and south are adjacent to it. In the area south of these there are large courtyards, cisterns, and several stone troughs. A logical solution here is that these were stables. On the southern side, as well, there are

deviations, including a protected expanse and rooms with a cistern.

3. The water system: Aside from the numerous cisterns in and around the enclosure, a dam and a central pool were constructed in Wadi Feiran, located about 0.2 km east of the site and much lower than it. The dam is about 15 m long and 2 m wide, with an artificial pool, 20x26 m in size, with 1 m high walls connected to it. Assuming that these originally reached a height of 1 m more, the pool could have held 1000 – 1200 cu m. A path runs from the dam along the slope up to the camp.

4. Road: Along the ridge between Wadi Feiran and Wadi esh-Shaqq is



485. Bird’s eye view to the south, of the camp at Kh. es-Suweideh. At right is the road descending into Wadi Feiran. The water reservoir of the camp is at left.

a road built of two parallel rows of large stones. This road, marked on the SWP map, apparently ascended from the area of Kh. es-Samrah (the Wadi Fau path) and descended to the Jordan Valley. This road was presumably paved.

5. Cemeteries: About 0.2 km west of the site, on a slope, two stone *sarcophagoi* were found *in situ* with their stone covers intact. On the slope east of the site, towards Wadi Feiran, there are several plundered burial caves. The central cemetery of the site was presumably in this area.

B. Chronology and history of the site:

Aside from site from the Bronze and Iron ages at Kh. es-Suweideh, at least two stages of the Roman camp can be discerned:

1. The camp was established in the 2nd Century C.E., when the original enclosure was built. Later the camp was enlarged and the extensions were added on. This is evident from the resemblance in building style and plan of the enclosure and its extension. The different stages are expressed by the



486. The ruins of the camp of Kh. es-Suweideh, looking north. The photo was taken from the tower on the southern part. Seated is R. Kimchi.

differences of plan.

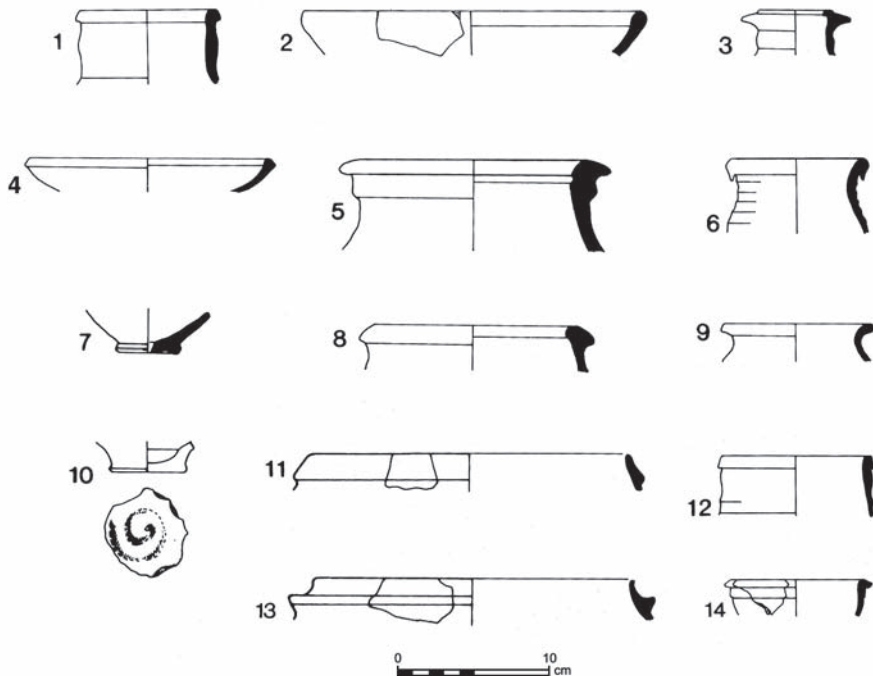
2. Some time after the construction of the original camp and its extensions, while the place was still functioning, a massive dismantling of structures and using the stones for changes in the structures, especially for blocking of streets, can be discerned. This blocking is visible in many streets and lanes, and its reasons are difficult to fathom without excavation.

3. The camp was abandoned and then used as courtyards or pens. This can probably be dated to the Byzantine Period.

Summary: The camp of Kh. es-Suweideh is a well-preserved and complete of the Roman military camps. Pottery and coin finds indicate its establishment to the 2nd Century C.E., with possible relation to the establishment of fortresses and other camps in the area. The historical sources related to this building are as yet unknown.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 5%; IrA IA-C – 5%; IrA II – 5%; Hel – 5%; ER – 10%; LR – 60%; Byz – 10%.

Coin find: Of the four coins, one is of Alexander Jannaeus, two are Provincial city-coins (Eliya Capitolina



487. Pottery from Kh. es-Suweideh, all from the Late Roman Period (2nd Century), unless otherwise noted: 1. Jar, lt br; 2. Bowl, lt br; 3. Juglet, dk; 4. Bowl, br; 5. Jar, yel, MBA II; 6. Jar, lt, Hel; 7. Jug base, br, MBA II; 8. Bowl, br, MBA II; 9. Jug, lt br; 10. Jug base, lt br; 11. CP of type B, IrA 1; 12. Jar, lt br; 13. CP, dk br, IA1; 14. Small bowl, lt br, Byz.

and Caesarea Maritima) from the time of Hadrian, and one from the Byzantine Period; see appendix.

Special find: Two arrowheads, a piece of jewelry, nails and pieces

of metal.

Bibliography: SWP II, 240; Hashman 1996.

Previous surveys: none.



488. Plan of the Roman camp at Kh. es-Suweideh, measured with an alidade. Note the basic rectangle of the camp and the additions to the east and west. The tower is in the center of the southern part.



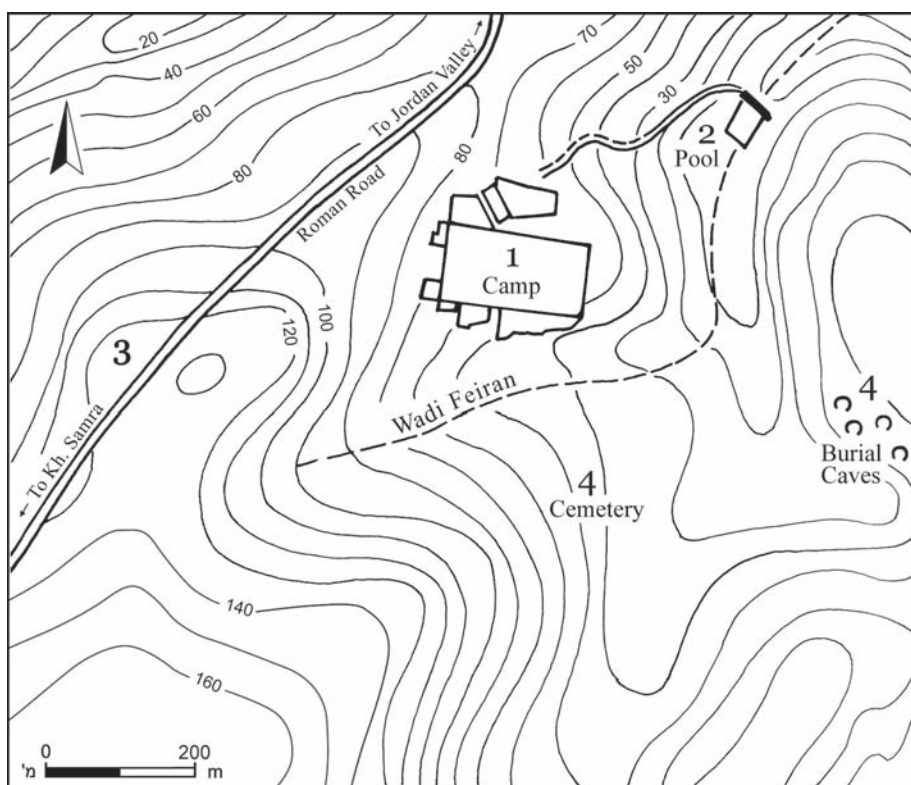
489. The built reservoir of the camp of Kh. es-Suweideh, looking west.



490. A decorated stone *sarcophagus*, to the west of Kh. es-Suweideh.



491. The two sides of a bronze coin of Eliya Capitolina (Roman Jerusalem) dated to Hadrian.



492. Plan of the area of Kh. es-Suweideh. 1. the camp; 2. the water reservoir; 3. the built road to the Jordan Valley; 4. the concentration of *sarcophagi* and the cemetery.

Site 240: 19 – 18/87/1

Umm ez-Zoqeh

Israel grid: 1982 1875

UTM grid: 7364 5747

Elevation: 150 m a.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: courtyard

Area: 0.5 dunam (0.13 acre)

Topography: plateau and high slope

Rock type: Mount Scopus formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 3

Cultivation: none

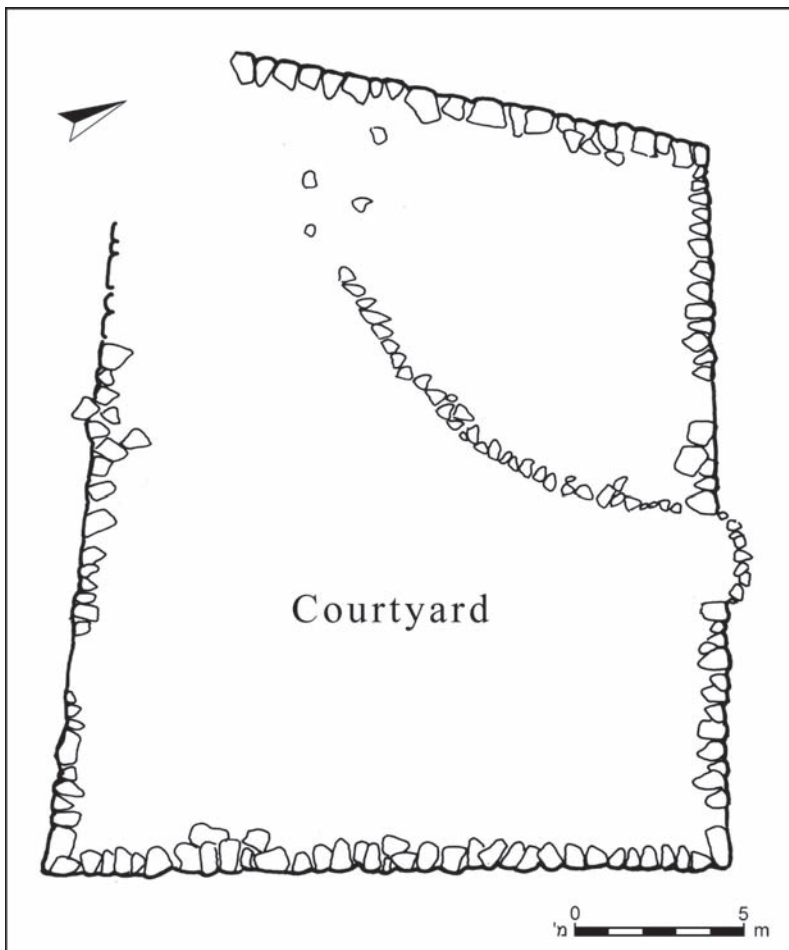
Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: springs ('Uyun Hilu, no. 88), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Wadi el-Far'ah – Tel el-Hilu (C23), 2 km distant

Visibility: 6

Jun. 10, 1988; 21 shards



493. Plan of the Byzantine courtyard of Umm ez-Zoqeh.

A rectangular courtyard on a southern slope of a ridge in the hilly block of Umm ez-Zoqeh, 1 km north of Peles and adjacent to the road of Ma'aleh Shai.

The courtyard, about 20x25 m in size, is built at the top of a terraced slope overlooking a deep ravine. The surrounding wall is of large field stones whose average dimensions are 0.6x0.6 m. Possible entrances were found in the north

and west, and collapsed cistern is in the north. A large terebinth tree (*Pistacia Atlantica*) grows in the southwest corner of the courtyard.

According to local tradition, the terebinth tree of Umm ez-Zoqeh is sacred, and heals barren women and various illnesses. We heard this tradition from shepherds from various places in the area.

Pottery: Byz – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 241: 19 – 18/97/1

Khalil el-'Adseh

Israel grid: 1996 1877

UTM grid: 7376 5747

Elevation: 70 m a.s.l., 30 m b.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin and enclosures

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: ravine

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: springs ('Uyun Hilu, no. 88), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Wadi el-Far'ah – Tel el-Hilu (C23), 3 km distant

Visibility: 3

Jun. 17, 1988; Feb. 13, 1993; 24 shards

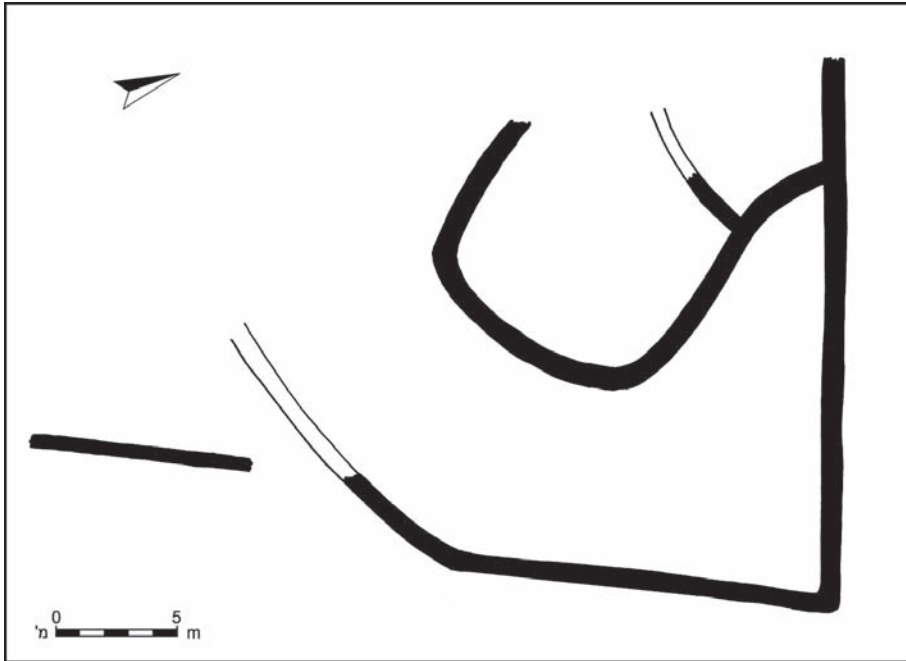
A small site in a broad ravine descending south from Kh. es-Suweideh, about 1 km south of that site.

There are two built enclosures, one within the other. The largest is square-shaped, 25x25 m in size and surrounded by a 1 m wide wall.

Inside it there is an inner enclosure with rounded corners. It seems that two structures stood inside the enclosures, but their plan is unclear.

Pottery: Chal – 2%; IrA II – 3%; Byz – 95%.

Previous surveys: none.



494. The built enclosures of Khalil el-'Adseh.



Site 242: 19 – 18/96/2

Khalil es-Sa'h

Israel grid: 1999 1865

UTM grid: 7389 5739

Elevation: 65 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: courtyard

Area: 0.5 dunam (0.13 acre)

Topography: plateau

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 2

Nearest water source: springs ('Uyun Hilu, no. 88), 7 km distant

Nearest road: Wadi el-Far'ah – Tel el-Hilu (C23), 3.5 km distant

Visibility: 5

Dec. 30, 1988; 14 shards

* * *

A courtyard on a plateau, 1.5 km east of Peles (Umm ez-Zoqeh). To the north are two deep Wadis - Qa'ud 'Ideh and Khalil el-'Adseh.

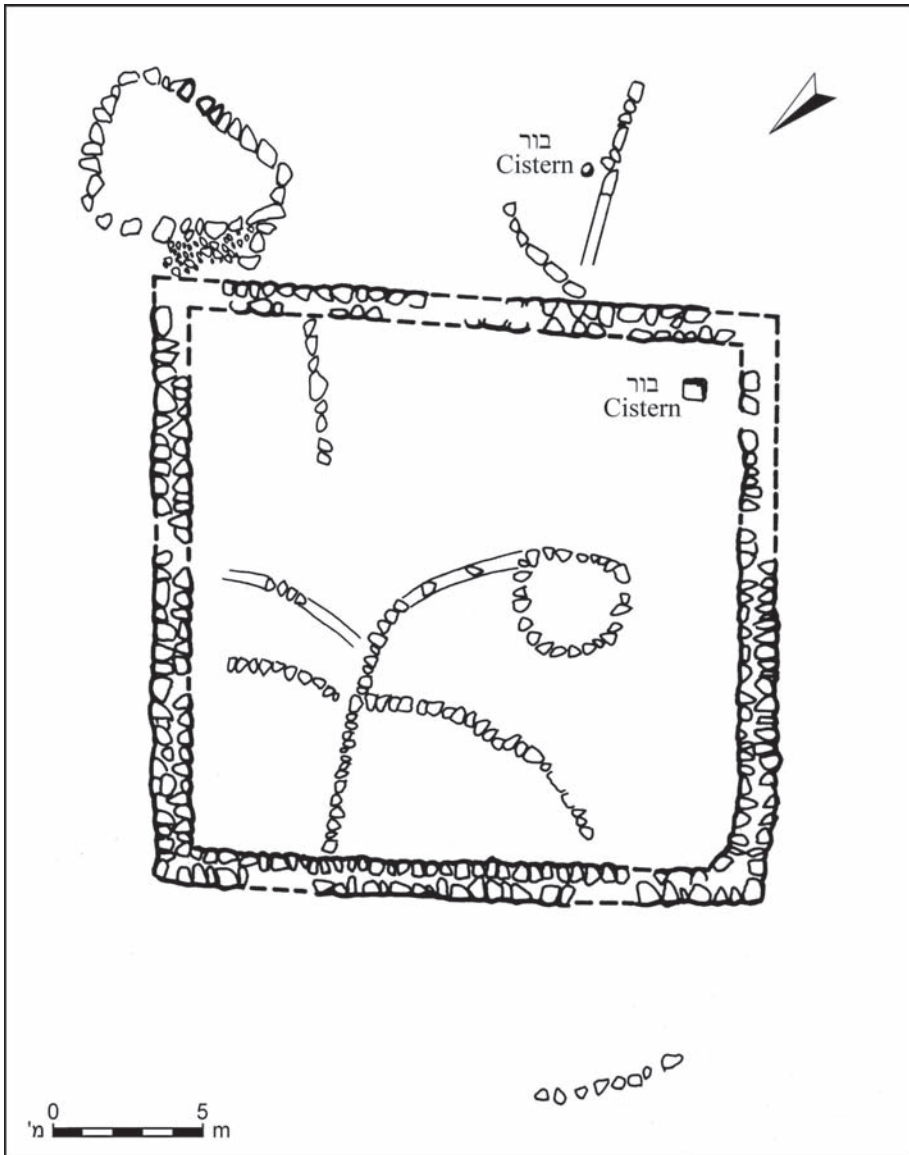
The courtyard is about 18x18 m in size, surrounded by a wall 1.5 m wide, built of two rows of large stones. The walls inside appear to

be of a later date. One cistern is in the southern corner and a second outside of the courtyard. Outside of the eastern corner is an elliptical-shaped structure.

Pottery: Byz – 100%.

Flint find: Three pieces from an unidentified period.

Previous surveys: none.



495. Plan of the courtyard of Khalil es-Sa'h.



496. The Byzantine courtyard of Khalil es-Sa'h, looking northeast. In the background are the ranges near Kh. es-Suweideh.



Site 243: 19 – 18/96/1

Abu Firan

Israel grid: 1995 1862

UTM grid: 7377 5737

Elevation: 50 m a.s.l., 30 m b.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small site and farm

Area: 0.5 dunam (0.13 acre)

Topography: valley

Rock type: Mount Scopus formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: springs ('Uyun Hilu, no. 88), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Wadi el-Far'ah – Tel el-Hilu (C23), 4 km distant

Visibility: 2

Apr. 7, 1989; 42 shards

A site in a small, internal valley, about 1 km east of Peles. Next to it runs a dirt road from the Hemdat road to Kh. es-Suweideh.

On a small bump west of the dirt road are remains of a structure, about 4x6 m in size, built of field stones. A medium-sized shard scat-

ter was found there.

Pottery: IrA II – 30%; Byz – 70%.

The site appears to be a farm or a seasonal structure.

Previous surveys: none.



497. The small farm of Abu Firan, looking west. In the background is Peles Range.



Site 244: 19 – 18/95/1

Peles (1)

Israel grid: 1992 1858

UTM grid: 7373 5728

Elevation: 70 m a.s.l., 50 m b.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small site

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: valley

Rock type: Mount Scopus formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest

soil; quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Jordan River
(no. 112), 4.5 km distant

Nearest road: Wadi el-Far'ah – Tel el-
Hilu (C23), 3 km distant

Visibility: 1

May 5, 1989; 27 shards

A small site on the edge of an in-

ner valley, about 1 km south east of